

/ Fukuoka

CINEMATIC SHORT · ~90 SECONDS · 16 SHOTS · 4 ACTS

YOUR KIT	Osmo Pocket 3 · Osmo Action 4 · Sony A7CII 24-70mm f/2.8 · iPhone 17 Pro Max
COLOR GRADE	Pull highlights warm (orange/amber) · Push shadows cool (teal/green) · Slightly desaturated midtones. Think Tokyo Drift, not Instagram filter.

ACT 01	Arrival	0:00 – 0:20
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Establish the place. No rush.

#01	Train window — city blurring past	<i>motion blur</i>
HOW TO FILM Press your phone or camera against the window to reduce vibration. Set shutter speed to 1/30s or slower. Landscape orientation. Let the city streak. Stay fixed — don't track anything. SETTINGS Shutter 1/30–1/50 · Static camera · Wide or normal lens · Shoot through glass		
GEAR	Osmo Pocket 3 — press flat against the window, gimbal absorbs train vibration. iPhone works too but Pocket 3 handles motion blur more cleanly.	
PRO TIP	Shoot in the direction of travel, not perpendicular — the parallel blur is more cinematic and less nauseating.	

#02	Feet stepping onto platform	<i>ground-level</i>
HOW TO FILM Set camera on the ground or as low as possible, pointing upward slightly. Frame so feet enter from the left and step toward camera. The gap between train and platform makes a natural leading line. SETTINGS Low angle / ground level · Wide lens · Look up slightly · Normal shutter		
GEAR	Osmo Action 4 — built for ground-level, wide angle is perfect here, and small enough to set on the platform floor without drawing attention.	
PRO TIP	Shoot twice — once normal, once slow-mo (60fps) for more control in edit.	

#03

Hakata Station exterior — golden hour

hold 3–4 sec

HOW TO FILM

Shoot during the 30 minutes before sunset. Cross the street and get far enough back for the full facade. Use a tripod. Frame symmetrically. Hold the shot for at least 8 seconds in-camera.

SETTINGS

Golden hour · Tripod or stable surface · Wide shot · Symmetrical framing

GEAR

Sony A7CII at 24mm — the sensor handles golden hour dynamic range far better than any of the others. This is your hero wide shot.

PRO TIP

Expose for the sky, not the building — a slightly silhouetted station with a warm sky is more dramatic than a flat bright exposure.

#04

Narrow alley with lanterns overhead

static, let motion happen

HOW TO FILM

Plant your camera at one end of the alley looking down — lanterns in foreground, depth receding. Don't follow people. Let them walk through the frame naturally. Shoot 20–30 seconds and pick the best moment in edit.

SETTINGS

Static tripod · Dusk or evening · Normal or slight telephoto · Let subjects pass

GEAR

Sony A7CII or Osmo Pocket 3 — Sony for image quality in low lamp light; Pocket 3 if you want to move through the alley smoothly without a tripod.

PRO TIP

Shoot when it's lightly busy — not crowded, not empty. A few silhouettes in warm lantern light beats a busy crowd.

ACT 02

The City Breathes

0:20 – 0:55

Layer urban life, food, and culture. This is the heart.

#05

Yatai stall — steam rising from ramen bowl

backlit, tight

HOW TO FILM

Position yourself so the light source is directly behind the bowl. Get as close as your lens allows — fill the frame with bowl and steam. Film at 60fps and slow to 24fps in edit for a dreamy steam effect.

SETTINGS

60fps slow-mo · Backlit · Tight / macro · Expose for highlights

GEAR

Sony A7CII at 70mm f/2.8 — compression and beautiful bokeh on the steam. Nothing else in your kit matches this for the backlit steam look.

PRO TIP

Ask the chef politely before filming. The steam is most dramatic in the first 30 seconds after serving.

#06

Chef's hands — ladle, broth pour

close-up, slow motion

HOW TO FILM

Film at 60–120fps. Tight frame on hands and ladle only — no face needed, less intrusive. Capture the moment broth hits the bowl. Side-lit from kitchen light. Rest on the counter edge for stability.

SETTINGS

60–120fps · Extreme close-up · Side-lit · Stabilize on surface

GEAR

iPhone 17 Pro Max — 120fps in a tight space, discreet, and the macro lens is excellent for hands. Rest it on the counter edge.

PRO TIP

Film multiple pours — you'll cut to a 1–2 second clip in edit, so volume is your friend.

#07

Canal reflection — Nakasu district at dusk

wide, symmetrical

HOW TO FILM

Find a bridge or bank where you can include both actual lights and their reflection in one frame. Sweet spot: 20–30 minutes after sunset. Tripod essential. Center the waterline for maximum symmetry.

SETTINGS

Blue hour · Tripod essential · Wide lens · Center the waterline

GEAR

Sony A7CII on tripod — blue hour is low light; the full-frame sensor holds clean shadows where other cameras get noisy. 24mm end.

PRO TIP

A slow zoom out (2–3 seconds) from the reflection to the full scene makes a beautiful transition cut.

#08

Shrine gate (torii) — looking up

silhouette okay

HOW TO FILM

Stand directly underneath the torii and point camera straight up or at a steep angle. Expose for the sky — let the gate go dark. A slow tilt from base to top adds movement without needing to walk.

SETTINGS

Looking up · Expose for sky · Slow tilt up · Silhouette okay

GEAR

Osmo Action 4 — ultra-wide angle exaggerates the gate's height. Sony at 24mm tilted up gives a more controlled, cinematic look.

PRO TIP

Sumiyoshi or Kushida Shrine in Hakata. Early morning is best — few tourists, soft light.

#09 Incense smoke curling at a temple

rack focus: smoke to face

HOW TO FILM

Frame smoke filling the foreground, then rack focus to someone praying in the background. Manual focus: do a slow pull. Auto: tap to focus on background and let smoke go soft in front.

SETTINGS

Rack focus · Backlit smoke · Wide aperture f/2.8 · Side or back light

GEAR Sony A7CII at 70mm f/2.8 — this shot lives by depth of field. The rack focus from smoke to face is not achievable with the other cameras.

PRO TIP Shoot when sun is at a low angle behind the burner — the smoke becomes luminous against a darker background.

#10 Busy intersection — slow-mo crowd

tripod, wide

HOW TO FILM

Find a corner or elevated position near Tenjin or Hakata station. Set wide and static. Shoot at 60fps. Don't follow any one person — let the whole crowd flow. 30 seconds gives you many usable 3–4 second clips.

SETTINGS

60fps slow-mo · Tripod or elevated perch · Wide lens · Static — don't follow

GEAR Osmo Pocket 3 — compact enough in a crowd without being invasive. Gimbal handles urban bustle. iPhone works too.

PRO TIP Tenjin underground city exits during rush hour (5–7pm) give great crowd flow with directional light from above.

ACT 03

Stillness

0:55 – 1:20

Pull back. Find the quiet.

#11 Empty early-morning street — soft light

golden hour AM, mist if lucky

HOW TO FILM

Set your alarm. 6–7am streets that were packed at midnight are near-empty. Look for long straight streets with perspective lines to the horizon. Static, wide. Don't correct morning haze in-camera.

SETTINGS

Golden hour AM · Static wide · Leading lines · Don't correct haze in-camera

GEAR Sony A7CII — the full-frame sensor renders morning haze and warmth beautifully. 24mm on a tripod. Pocket 3 if traveling light.

PRO TIP A lone vending machine glowing on a quiet street is a very Fukuoka image. Keep an eye out.

#12 Someone eating alone at a yatai counter

respectful distance, candid

HOW TO FILM

Frame from outside the yatai, shooting through the open side. Use a longer focal length so you're not in their space. Focus on bowl, hands, warm light — not the face.

SETTINGS

Telephoto or crop · Outside looking in · Warm artificial light · Candid — don't stage

GEAR iPhone 17 Pro Max — most discreet. Cinematic mode gives a natural rack focus. Don't pull out the Sony here; it draws too much attention.

PRO TIP If eating there yourself, set your camera on the counter pointed slightly outward — cameras that blend in get the best candid shots.

#13 Ocean or park — wide, breathing room

Nokonoshima or Seaside Momochi

HOW TO FILM

Go wide — sky in at least half the frame. Shoot static and let the world breathe. A very slow zoom out (1cm over 5 seconds) works well handheld. This is about space and silence after Act 2.

SETTINGS

Ultra wide · Sky dominant · Slow or static · Horizon level

GEAR Sony A7CII at 24mm for the wide shot. On the Nokonoshima ferry, use Osmo Action 4 (waterproof, stable on a railing) to film the Fukuoka skyline receding over water.

PRO TIP The ferry ride to Nokonoshima is worth filming in itself — the receding skyline from the water is a view few tourists capture.

#14 Close-up detail — leaf, coin, menu

abstract, grounding

HOW TO FILM

Collect these throughout the trip. Look for textures, Japanese typography, worn surfaces. Get as close as your lens allows, focus on one small area, let everything blur. Shoot 10 options and pick in edit.

SETTINGS

Macro / closest focus · Wide aperture · Shallow depth of field · Collect throughout trip

GEAR Sony A7CII at 70mm f/2.8 for the bokeh detail look. iPhone 17 Pro Max macro mode for truly tiny subjects where the Sony can't focus close enough.

PRO TIP Wet stone, bamboo, and sand grade beautifully with the warm-shadows palette. Rainy days are great for texture shots.

#15

Train leaving platform — static shot

symmetrical if possible

HOW TO FILM

Stand at end of platform facing down the track. Frame symmetrically with tracks as leading lines. Let the train depart in front of you. Hold the shot a few seconds after the train is gone — that empty track is the real closing image.

SETTINGS

End of platform · Symmetrical framing · Static · Hold after train departs

GEAR

Sony A7CII at 24mm for widest symmetrical framing. Osmo Pocket 3 if you want a smoother handheld hold while waiting.

PRO TIP

Shinkansen at Hakata is most dramatic. Nishitetsu lines have a classic Japan rail aesthetic for something quieter.

#16

Black fade — title card optional

edit only

HOW TO FILM

Done in editing. Fade the last shot to black over 1.5 seconds. Hold on black for 2 seconds. If adding a title card, keep it minimal — white text, small and centered.

SETTINGS

Edit only · Fade to black 1.5s · Hold 2s · Music fade with it

GEAR

No camera needed — this is a post-production step in your editing software.

PRO TIP

The music should fade with the image, not cut abruptly. A natural decay of 2–3 seconds feels right.

MUSIC

Lo-fi jazz, Japanese city pop instrumental, or a single piano line. Nujabes-adjacent. Look for a slow build — peaks around 0:45–1:00 to match Act 2 energy, then naturally winds down for Acts 3–4.